



Gary
Chamber
of
Commerce

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FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION

December 13, 2011

Ms. Karen V. Gregory
Secretary
Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol Street, NW
Washington, DC 20573-0001

Subject: Docket No. 11-19, *U.S. Containerized Cargo Flows – Response to NOI*

Dear Madam Secretary:

The Gary Chamber of Commerce is submitting these comments in response to the Federal Maritime Commission's Notice of Inquiry on factors that may cause or contribute to the shift of cargo destined for the U.S. inland from U.S. to Canadian and Mexican seaports.

Canada and the United States share the world's largest and most important bilateral trade relationship in the world with 8 million U.S. jobs dependent on free and efficient trade with Canada. Businesses on both sides of the border depend on efficient supply chains to compete in the global economy. Here in our home state of Indiana, more than 162,000 jobs are dependent on that free and efficient trade. Also, in Gary, Indiana, one of our city's largest employers, CN, is engaged in that North American trade.

Trade between the United States and Canada, as well as the ability to choose from among a variety of North American ports or overall supply chains for imports and exports, are essential to the success of the businesses we represent here in Northwest Indiana. Like all businesses, we believe shippers make routing choices based on many factors such as cost, reliability and efficiency. Measures that disrupt cross border transportation negatively impact U.S. importers and exporters, including those here in Northwest Indiana and the greater Chicago area. Indiana sells more goods to Canada than any other country in the world and as both an importer and exporter we believe in maintaining a free, open border that facilitates free trade for both nations.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on this issue. Please include this letter in the public docket for this proceeding.

Sincerely,

Charles (Chuck) Hughes
Executive Director
Gary Chamber of Commerce